



Module 2

Culture Shock

I

What will you find in this module?

► **You will be learning about:**

- The definition of Culture
- Culture shock
- Talking about sensitive topics

► **Get ready for the Hands On!**

- Let's make a podcast about cultural tips
- Let's plan a trip and an itinerary



Intermediate



PART 1

Travel and culture

SPEAKING

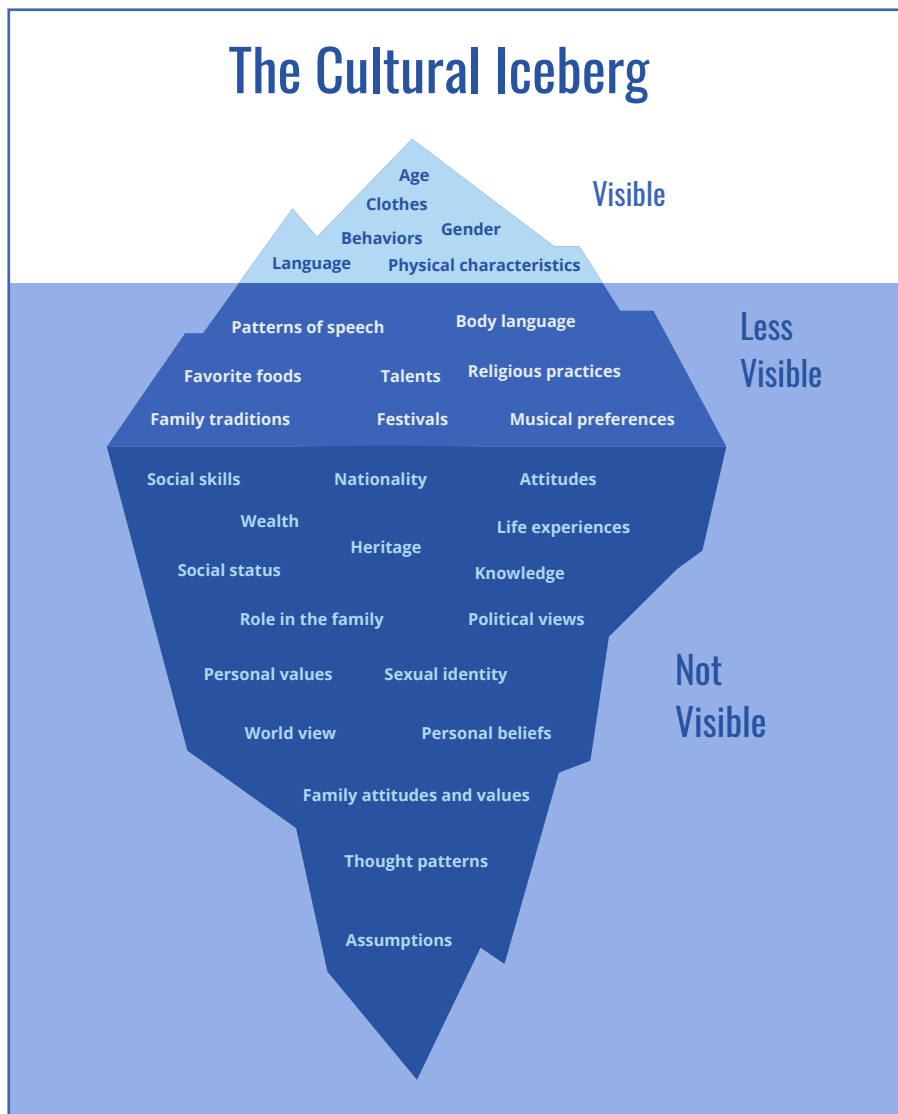
a. Discuss the following questions with a partner.

1. Do you prefer going on holiday to big cities or small towns? Why?
2. Have you ever traveled abroad? Where did you go?
3. Has any close friend or relative ever traveled abroad? Where did they go?

4. How was the experience for you or your friend/relative in that country?
5. If you had the opportunity to travel to another country, where would you go and why?
6. Would it be easy or difficult to adapt to the culture of that country?

b. In pairs or small groups, analyze “The Cultural Iceberg” image below. Highlight any new words or phrases that you are not familiar with, then try to find the meanings on an online dictionary such as these ones:

- » [Oxford Learner's Dictionaries](#)
- » [Merriam-Webster's Dictionary](#)



- c. Now use “The Cultural Iceberg” image to make a profile about Colombian culture by identifying the visible, less visible, and not visible aspects of it. Some examples have been provided. Write five more examples in each category.

The Cultural Iceberg of Colombia	
Visible	• Language(s): Spanish (official), creole, indigenous & <i>palenque</i> languages • • • • • •
Less visible	• Religious practices: Roman Catholicism/Christianity (most practiced), indigenous practices. • • • • • •
Not visible	• Assumptions: • • • • • •

- d. Discuss the follow question in small groups.

1. What do you think are aspects of Colombian culture that are difficult for foreigners to grasp? How and why?
2. What is a visible aspect of your culture that you are most proud of? Why?
3. What is a not visible aspect of your culture that you are most critical of? Why?

PART 2

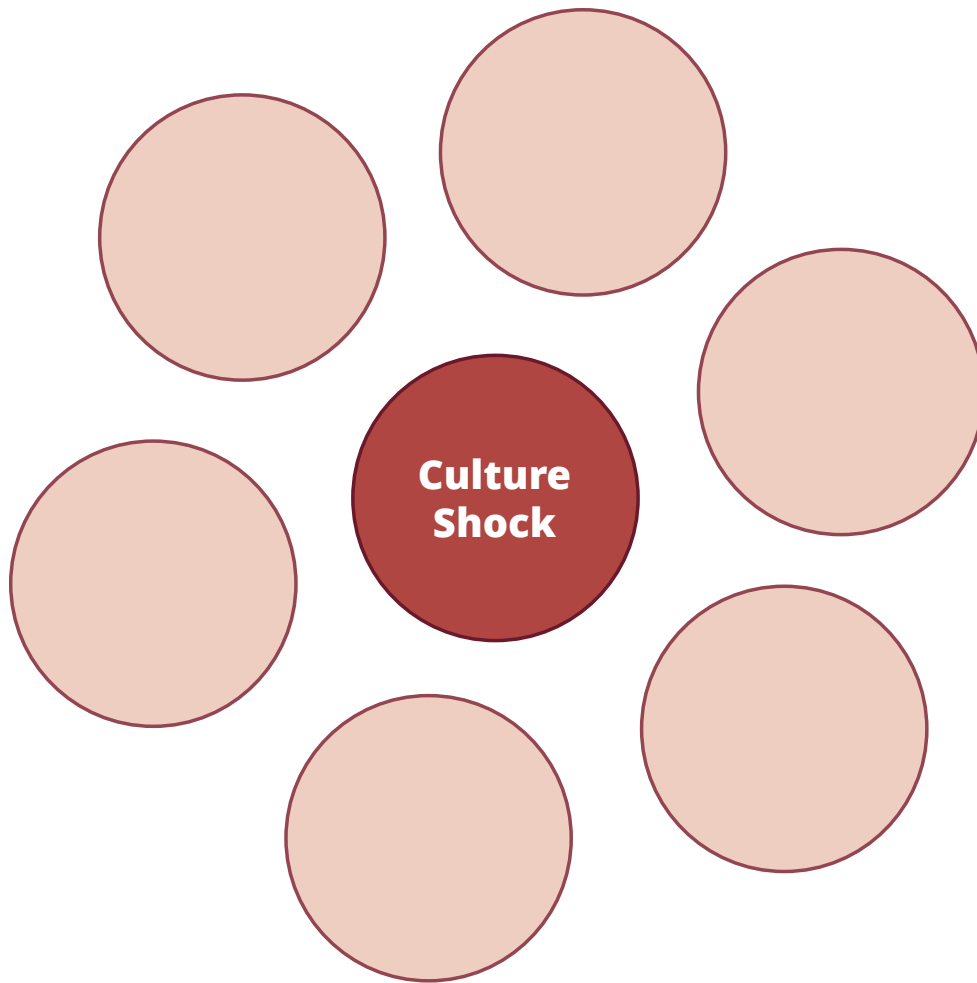
What is Culture Shock?

SPEAKING

- a. Discuss the follow question in small groups.

1. What do you think *culture shock* is?
2. Would you consider *culture shock* as something positive or negative?

- b. What words come to mind when you think about culture shock? With a partner, use the diagram on the following page to create a word map about it.



c. Share your diagrams with the rest of the class and add new words to your diagram from other classmates.

→ **GO TO VOCABULARY REFERENCE** *Culture Shock*

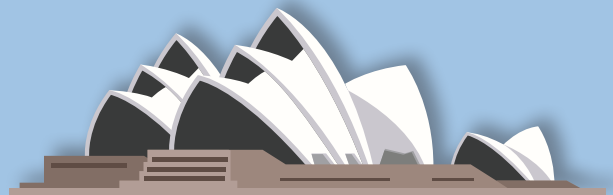
READING

Activity 1 - Culture shock - Going abroad

a. Read the following travel experiences of each student. Take note of their individual experiences.

Anna studies abroad in Australia

I was getting ready to fly to Australia at the age of 16 to go to high school for one year and live with a host family. I was completely over the moon with everything — and I mean everything! When the plane finally touched down in Sydney, I was so excited and exhilarated that I was finally in Australia; something we had been planning for many months...





Nora travels to New Zealand

It's always confusing to shop in a foreign country, but I had wrongly thought there wouldn't be any issues in New Zealand, where English is spoken, since I'm from England. Instead, everything had a different name. Peppers were no longer peppers, they were capsicums. Courgettes were zucchinis. Heinz was called Watties... and the list goes on. I'd find myself lost wandering around shops.

Chris moves to Colombia

After some time, I got used to people staring at me and yelling "gringo" as they passed by. I understood and accepted why. Because of my blonde hair and blue eyes, many people assumed I had lots of money. It didn't bother me anymore the fact that my friends would show up 30 minutes to an hour later than they said. I was finally able to recognize all the differences and actually enjoy them.



Images: <https://www.freepik.com> | <https://www.vecteezy.com>

b. Discuss the following questions with a partner about the three students' experiences.

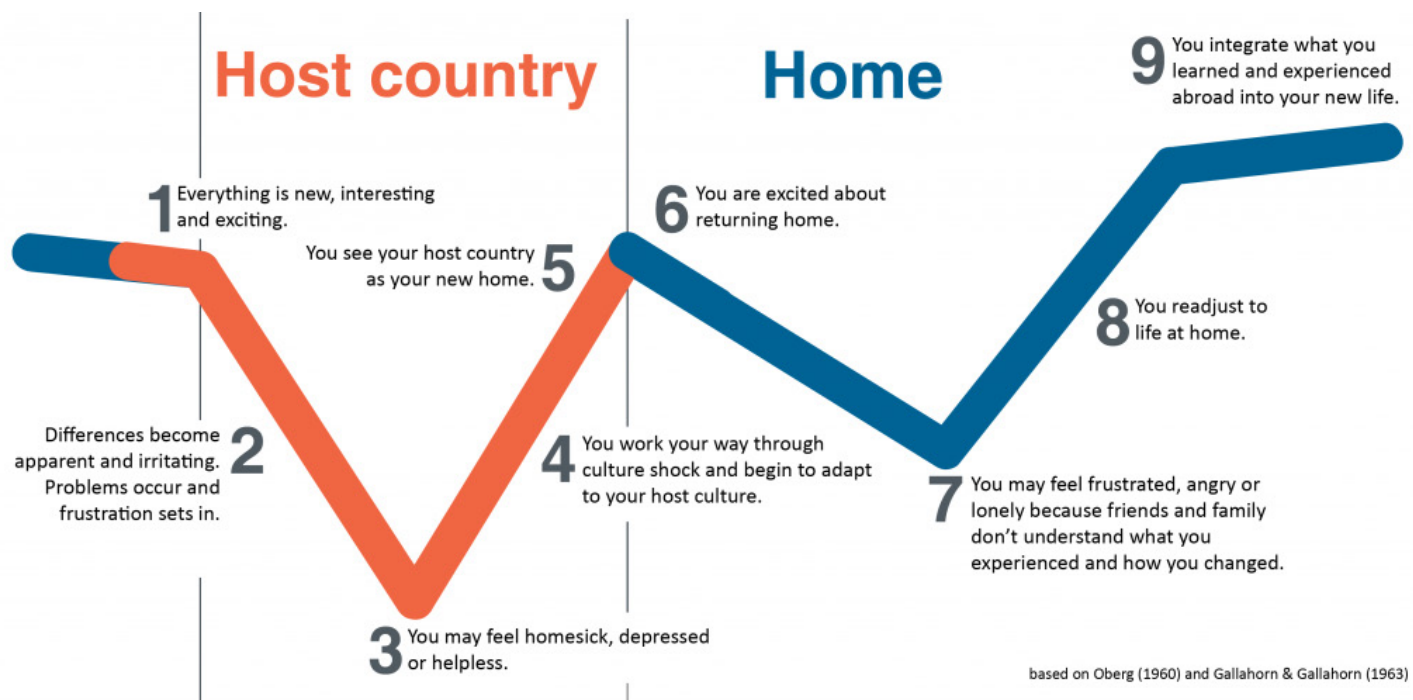
1. What is similar about the three experiences?
2. How are their experiences different?
3. In your opinion, who of them went through a difficult time? In what way?

SPEAKING

Activity 2 - Culture shock - The process of adjustment chart

a. Using the numbers from the graph on the next page, identify what phase of the "W" curve each person from exercise a experienced based on their stories.

1. Anna _____
2. Nora _____
3. Chris _____



Source: <https://insights.missouri.edu/the-reality-of-studying-abroad/>

b. Look at the following W curve that represents the stages of Culture Shock, then answer the questions in small groups.

1. Do you recognize any of these stages from your own experience?
2. Has anyone close to you gone through them?
3. Is it always the same for everyone or does it depend on the person? Explain.

LISTENING

a. Listen to Laney talking about her experiences while traveling abroad and dealing with cultural differences. Take as many notes as possible for each interview, then in pairs compare your notes so that you can answer the questions together.

1. What places did she visit and why did she do there?
2. Did she go through culture shock? If yes, how?
3. What stages from the previous "W" curve would you think Laney experienced?

Laney (click to listen)

b. Now answer the same questions from exercise a. for Anna, Camilo, and Racquel.

Anna (click to listen)

Racquel (click to listen)

Camilo (click to listen)

SPEAKING

a. Discuss the following questions with a partner. Then, read the text below.

1. What are some topics that people avoid talking about with strangers in your country?
2. Are any of these topics acceptable in other countries? If yes, which ones?
3. Has someone from a different country ever offended you? What did that person do?

Communication: Sensitive topics

[Link to the original article](#)

- (1) Many Americans are **sensitive** about certain subjects. These people are described as "politically correct." This means they try not to say things that will **offend** a particular group of people. For example they do not **tolerate** racist or sexist jokes. This **correctness** helps to create an **inclusive** society, but **it can cause problems if they think others are being disrespectful.**
- (2) Most Americans do not like to talk about their weight, their age, or how much money they make. **If you say something about someone's weight, how old they are, or how rich or poor they are, they might be upset.**
- (3) People also may not want to tell you where they are going or where they live. **If you ask someone, "Where are you going?" they may think you have a bad intention.**
- (4) Researchers have found there are some topics that are easier to talk about without having a communication problem. Common areas across cultures are children and sports. **If you are having a hard time talking to someone, you can try to talk about these topics.**

b. In pairs, discuss the meanings of the **highlighted** words.

USE OF ENGLISH TIP

First conditional and Modal verbs of possibility and ability

Look at the underlined expressions, they are examples verbs called **modals** (may, might, can). They can express *possibility* and *ability*.

The **phrases in red** are examples of **first conditionals**. They are used to express that something is possible to happen in the future if a condition in the present is met.

[Go to the Use of English Reference for more information](#)

c. Choose the correct answer based on the reading.

1. The first paragraph suggests

- a. Americans create groups that only include people that are similar to them.
- b. People in the U.S. try to respect the differences among people to make everyone feel comfortable.
- c. Talking about race or sex is offensive to people in the U.S.
- d. You shouldn't make jokes in the U.S. because the people are very sensitive.

2. The word **tolerate** in the first paragraph is closest in meaning to

- a. offer
- b. reject
- c. admit
- d. permit

3. According to the passage, all of the following would be inappropriate questions to ask EXCEPT:

- a. How heavy are you now?
- b. How old are you turning this year?
- c. How was the game last night?
- d. How much did the company offer you as salary?

4. The author mentions children and sports in the last paragraph in order to

- a. Offer support to a person having a hard time making conversation in the U.S.
- b. Suggest universally acceptable conversation topics
- c. Give examples of discussion topics to avoid
- d. Propose further topics for cross-cultural communication research

d. Read the dialogues and decide if each conversation is appropriate or inappropriate in the U.S context. Use evidence from the reading to support your answers. Then share your answers with a partner.

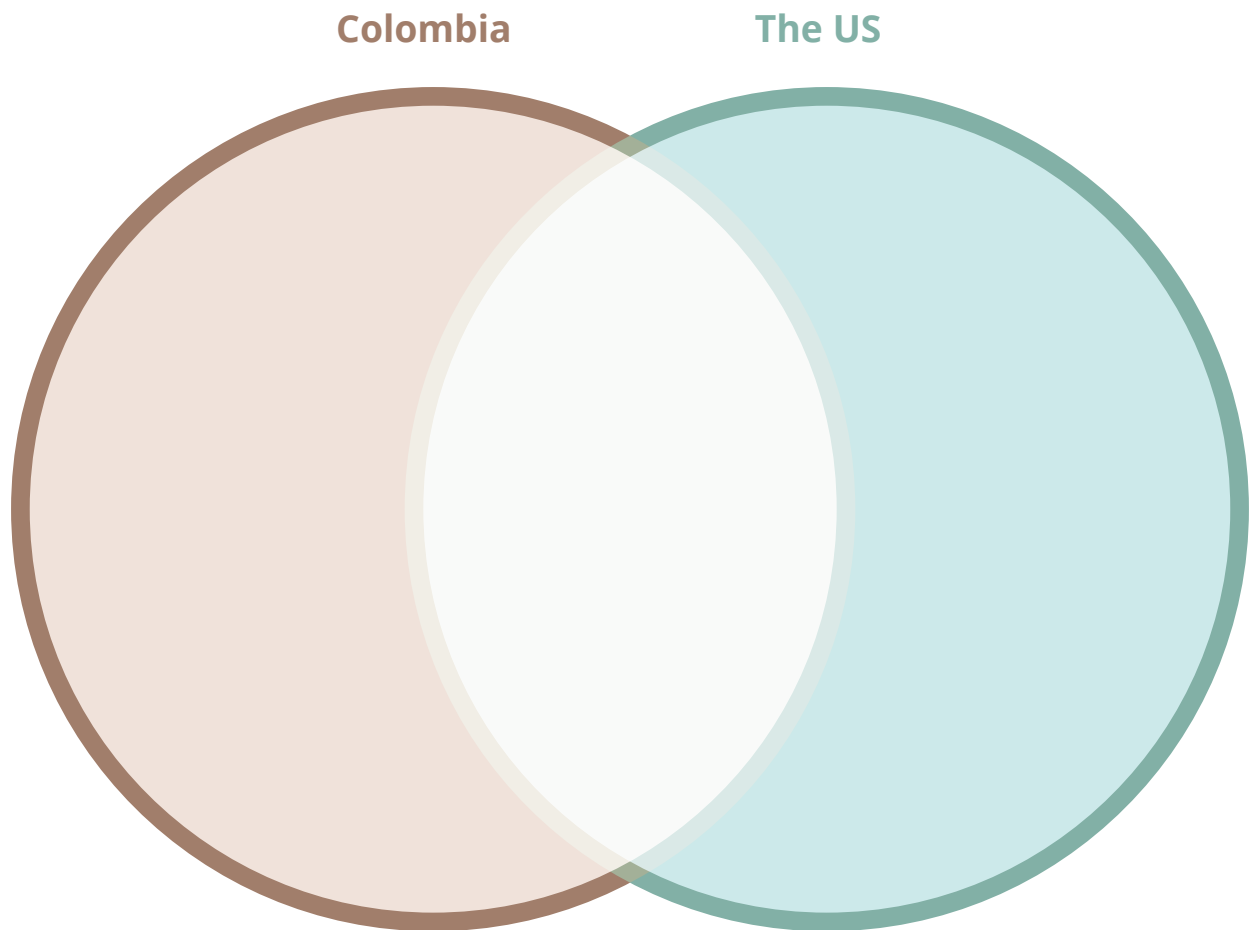
1. **Lupita:** Oh my gosh, Maritza! It's so great to see you. How long has it been? A year?
Maritza: Hi Lupita. It's so great to see you, too. I think you're right. It has been about a year. By the way, you look amazing! You were a little big last time I saw you but you look much slimmer now.
2. **Pedestrian:** Wow! That's a beautiful sports car.
Sports car owner: Thanks. I got it recently and I'm absolutely in love with it.
Pedestrian: I'd be in love, too. How much does a car like this cost anyway?
3. **Customer:** It's really cold out there today. Don't you think so?
Barista: It sure is. When it's cold like this all I want to do is stay home and watch NHL games.
Customer: Are you a big hockey fan?
Barista: Yes, I am. I grew up watching the Washington Capitals play.
4. **Driver:** [Beep! Beep!]. Do you see that idiot swerving in and out of traffic?
Passenger: Are you talking about the blue car?
Driver: Yeah. The driver must be a woman or Asian because you know both of them don't know how to drive
Passenger: Haha. I second that opinion.
5. **Cashier:** Aww. Your son is so cute! How old is he?
Shopper: Thank you. He'll be eight months next week.
Cashier: He's so precious. Kids are so adorable at that age.

SPEAKING

a. Discuss these two questions in small groups.

1. How would a person in your native country respond to the final statement in each dialogue?
2. What are some similarities and differences between how someone would react in your home culture versus the U.S.?

b. Complete the following Venn diagram based on your discussions. Compare communication styles and topics in the U.S. and your country. Use specific examples.





Module 2 Hands On

Planning a Trip & Travel Itinerary

Instructions

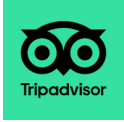
In groups of 3—4, plan a 5-day trip to a foreign destination with a comprehensive travel itinerary (including a budget, cultural tips, weather forecast, packing list, transportation, places to visit, etc.).

Include pre-departure information and resources that your group used to prepare for any potential culture shock, such as differences in communication style. **On the next page you'll find an example of itinerary.**

Get started

Look at these useful apps/websites to plan your trip. **You can click on them!** If you know any others, share them with your partners.



Useful apps & websites		
Research on travel tips, culture & customs	Culture Trip Lonely Planet	 
International travel	Google Travel Skyscanner	 
Transportation in-country	Uber GoogleMaps Cabify	  
Accommodations	AirBnB HostelWorld	 
Places to visit, restaurants	TripAdvisor	
Miscellaneous	XEcurrency	

Images: Each company's website

Example of Itinerary

Destination: Paris, France Travel dates: September 1 to September 6 Total spending budget (not including the flight): 3'000.000 COP / € 800.000 Cost of roundtrip flight:			
Transportation tips	Cultural tips / communication style	Budget (in COP & foreign currency)	Expected weather forecast
VISA? Taxis & Uber are available in Paris Paris Metro tickets cost: €1,90 Pack of 10 tickets: €14,90 Paris train tickets cost to Versailles:	Always say "Bonjour" (including "Au Revoir" "Bonne Journée" etc...) when interacting with others, service workers, etc.. Do not tip waiters. <u>DO NOT</u> talk about the following topics with French people: money/work <u>DO</u> talk about: geography, art, music, literature, history, getting good deals, food, holidays, language.	Flights: Accomodations: Food: Cultural activities:	

Date	Location	Activity	Transportation & Accommodations	Cost of Activity (in COP & EUR)	Notes
September 1	Bogotá, Colombia	Departure - Flight 9009 at 11:55pm	Air France		Bring passport, VISA, Euros
September 2	Paris, France	Arrival at Charles de Gaulle airport 5:30pm Travel to Paris city center & check into hostel	Line RER B Hotel Gavarni 5 Rue Gavarni, 16th arrondissement, Trocadero, Paris		Explore area around the hotel Have a late dinner
September 3	Paris, France	Ile de la Cite: Notre Dame Cathedral, Sainte-Chapelle, Pont Neuf	Take the metro		Nearest metro stop to the hotel: RER C
September 4	Paris, France	The Louvre Museum, Tuileries Garden, Concorde Square, D'Orsay Museum	Take the metro		Metro lines: 1 > 6
September 6	Paris, France > Bogotá, Colombia	Departure from Paris Arrival to Bogota:	Line RER B to the airport		



Module 2 Hands On

Make a podcast with cultural tips!



Instructions

After completing the LISTENING activity, you will create your own cultural podcast in small groups addressing issues of cultural shock for travellers. Pick a country/destination and do some research about it. Create a country profile and include information about customs/habits, norms/rules about food/eating, language(s), greetings, religious practices, significant holidays/festivals, women/the LGBTQ community, etc. or any other topic you find important for travellers to know.

Here are some examples of some legitimate/well-known travel and culture podcasts:

- [Zero to Travel](#)
- [The Thoughtful Travel](#)
- [Coming to Singapore](#) (this is an example with a specific country, Singapore)



Module 2

Academic Production

ACADEMIC WRITING: EXPOSITORY PARAGRAPH

1. Hook (H):

captures the audience's attention and generates interest in your message.

4. Supporting Detail (SD): provides examples or data to strengthen argument that was made in the supporting sentence.

Parts of a paragraph

Escape your everyday stress by flying to another country. Travelling abroad is important for two main reasons. First of all, you can learn new things about different cultures. For example, you can learn a new language. People sometimes travel just to learn a different languages, such as English in countries like the United Kingdom, the United States, or Australia. Second, people do other cultural activities such as sightseeing, dining, and excursions. You can taste new things and see new places. For these two reasons, travelling abroad is an important educational learning experience.

2. Topic Sentence (TS):

state the person or thing that will be discussed in the paragraph as well as the most important idea that the writer wants the reader to know about the topic.

3. Supporting Sentences (SS):

reinforce the main idea introduced in the topic sentence and shows why that idea is correct.

5. Concluding sentence (CS):

restates the idea stated in the topic sentence, summarize points presented in the paragraph or calls on the reader to take action.



Module 2

Academic Production

ACADEMIC WRITING: EXPOSITORY PARAGRAPH

- a. Read the sentences below and decide what is its role in the paragraph. Next, write numbers to indicate the correct order of the sentences in the paragraph.

Sentence	Role	Order
Additionally, Madagascar requires US to get a visa at the airport which cost between \$28 and \$50 depending on the length of stay.	SD	
To ensure that you can enjoy your international vacation without any problem, make sure that you do your research before going to the airport.		
For one thing, tipping servers is considered rude in Japan even though it is common place in the U.S.		
Another issue is assuming that you will be able to function without knowing the local language.		
For example, Brazil requires travellers from the U.S. to apply for a visitors visa beforehand.		
Similarly, a working knowledge of Spanish is needed to avoid being taken advantage of in the popular tourist city of Cartagena because there are some people that purposefully target foreigners to to overcharge them for services and disappear when there is a problem.		
Making assumptions about things when travelling internationally can best cause inconveniences or uncomfortable situations.		
In addition, it is considered rude for men to show skin in South Korea including at the beach.		
For starters, assuming that you don't need a visa because you are travelling with a U.S. passport.		
Finally, assuming that some customs are universal can cause uncomfortable situations.		
You bought your tickets, packed your bags and booked your hotel room, however, are you forgetting something?		
Many visit Brazil and believe they will be able to get by because they know English or Spanish; however, spoken Brazilian Portuguese sounds very different from both English and Spanish.		



Module 2

Academic Production

ACADEMIC WRITING: EXPOSITORY PARAGRAPH

COMPARE AND CONTRAST

When analyzing two or more things, it is common to compare and contrast them. To compare two things is to state how they are the same or similar while to contrast is to state how they are different. There are several linking devices to show similarities and differences between ideas.

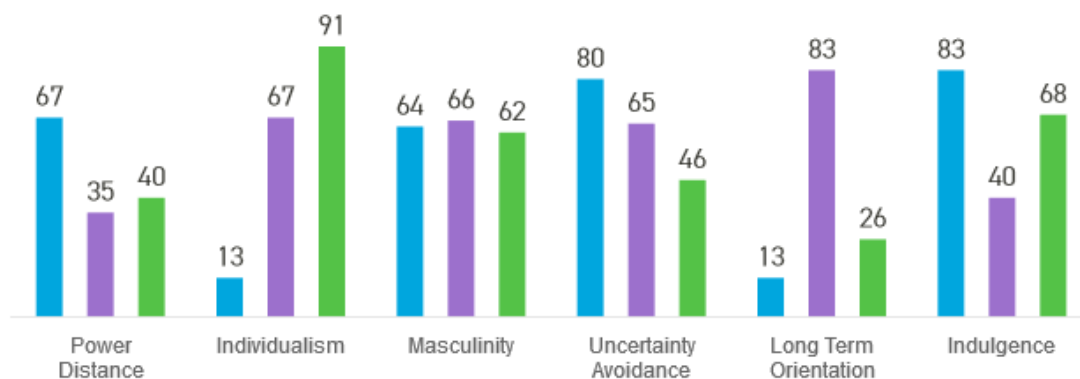
Write the words in the correct box.

similarly	comparable	conversely	in contrast	unlike	in the same way
by the same token	whereas	on the other hand	however	as with	likewise

Comparison	Contrast

Look at Geert Hofstede's Cultural Dimension Country Comparison chart and complete the paragraph on the next page with the appropriate linking device from the previous activity.

Colombia × Germany × United States ×



Source: <https://www.hofstede-insights.com/product/compare-countries/>



Module 2

Academic Production

ACADEMIC WRITING: EXPOSITORY PARAGRAPH

For years, many people have sought to create a system to categorize culture. Geert Hofstede was one of those people and his system of cultural dimensions has been used to overcome cultural differences worldwide. He created a comparison charting tool to view the cultural similarities and differences side by side. For example, the chart above shows that Colombia's masculinity dimension which reflects assertiveness is (1) _____ to that of Germany and the United States. (2) _____, Colombia scores lower than both countries in terms of individualism and long term orientation. This means that Colombia's low score individualism makes it more likely that they have stronger family and community connections (3) _____ these types of relationships are not as common in Germany and the U.S. Moreover, Colombia is very short term oriented which means that it maintains its traditions and is wary of societal change. (4) _____, Germany and the U.S. are more long term oriented. This means that they encourage people to innovate as a way to prepare for the future. Tools such as Hofstede's Country Comparison Tool helps us to better understand our differences and work more effectively together.

ACTIVITY

In a small group, write an outline for a paragraph that gives advice to foreigners visiting your country. Be sure to note comparisons and contrasts between your country and others when useful. Select one of the following topics:

- restaurant etiquette
- clothing/fashion
- transportation etiquette (taxis, public transportation)
- perception of time/punctuality
- spatial proximity/awareness (proxemics)

VOCABULARY REFERENCE

CULTURE SHOCK

a. Match the definitions to the given words.

Word	Letter	Definition
Culture Shock		A. a thing that is accepted as true or as certain to happen, without proof
Stage		B. remove from something or somewhere
Abroad		C. an abrupt and unaccountable change of mood
Comfort Zone		D. the core principles and ideals upon which an entire community exists
Take out		E. in or to a foreign country or countries
Separation Anxiety		F. a point, period, or step in a process or development
Prejudice		G. the phenomenon of interpreting and judging phenomena by standards inherent to one's own culture
Mood Swings		H. a situation where one feels safe or at ease
Withdrawal		I. a widely held but fixed and oversimplified image or idea of a particular type of person or thing
Bewilderment		J. anxiety provoked by separation or the threat of separation from familiar people, places and things
Cultural Values		K. the impact of moving from a familiar culture to an unfamiliar one
Cultural Bias		L. a feeling of being perplexed and confused
Assumptions		M. the action of ceasing to participate in an activity
Stereotypes		N. preconceived opinion that is not based on reason or actual experience

VOCABULARY REFERENCE

CULTURE SHOCK

PLACE AND NATIONALITY IDIOMS

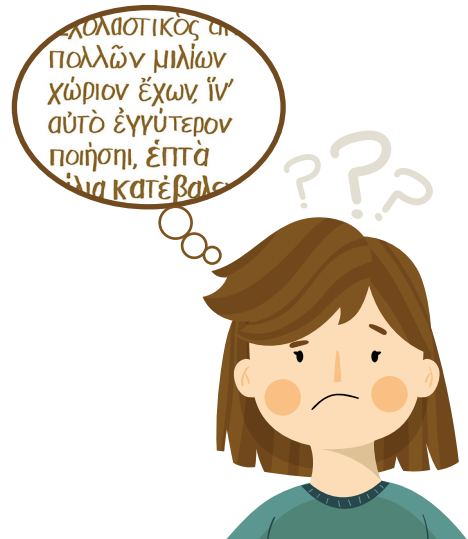
- a. Look at the images and infer the meaning of the idioms. Then, replace the **bolded expressions** with one of the idiomatic expressions.



Pardon my French!



Go dutch!



It's all greek to me!



A New York minute



When in Rome...

The first time I visited Córdoba, Argentina I felt very lost. Although I had studied Spanish for years, understanding what the people were saying was **meaningless and incomprehensible**. They used completely different words and verb forms. Because of this, there were many moments that when I used phrases that were inappropriate and I had to ask people to **forgive me for using offensive words**. That said, the cultural differences were the most challenging part. For example, in the U.S. when a friend invites you to lunch it is assumed that you'll be **paying equal shares for the bill** while in Argentina the person that extends the invitation is the one who is expected to pay. Another difference is that in the U.S. many things are done in a **very fast manner** but things are done more slowly there. Eventually, I decided that **I should follow the local customs since I was visiting the place**.

Images
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<https://kknews.cc>
<http://www.clker.com>

USE OF ENGLISH REFERENCE

FIRST CONDITIONAL

We form first conditional sentences with the verb in the present simple in the if clause, and will + verb in the result clause:

- *If I win our tennis match, Dan will be very annoyed.*

We use the first conditional to talk about a future possibility when we feel confident about our predictions:

- *If they don't leave right now, they'll miss the train.*

We use the first conditional to talk about things that are possible in the future. This might be in a warning:

- *If you don't apologize, Keith will be very cross.*
- *If you don't get up now, you'll miss the bus.*

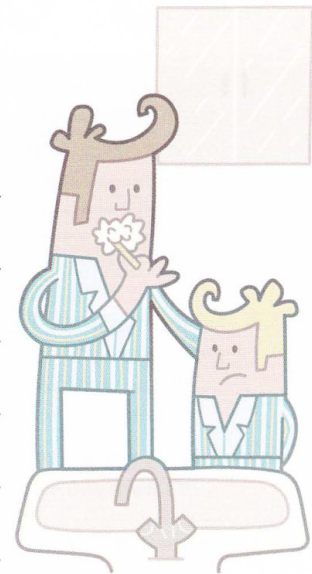
We also use the first conditional to make realistic predictions about our lives in the future:

- *If I fail my exams, I won't get into university.*

Father and son

Use the words given to make first conditional sentences including *if* and *will* and any necessary changes.

- 0 you / not / brush / your teeth / they / go / bad
If you don't brush your teeth, they'll go bad.
- 1 you / eat / all your vegetables / I / give / you some dessert
- 2 you / have / stomach ache / you / eat / too many plums
- 3 I / help / you with your homework / you / do / the washing-up?
- 4 you / not / go to bed now / you / be / tired in the morning
- 5 your mother / be / cross / you / come home late



Family finances

Complete this family discussion by using first conditionals with the words in brackets.

- MUM We've got problems and if we *don't change* ⁰ (not, change), things *will get* ⁰ (get) worse.
- DAD And we definitely ¹ (not, be) able to have a holiday if we ² (not, save) some money every month.
- DELLA With petrol so expensive, if you two ³ (stop) using two cars, you ⁴ (save) a lot of money.
- ALEX And you ⁵ (not, need) any bus money if you ⁶ (go) to school on your bike.
- DELLA I ⁷ (not, be) able to use it unless someone ⁸ (mend) the puncture.
- ALEX Perhaps I should get a Saturday job. I ⁹ (not, need) any pocket money if I ¹⁰ (earn) some of my own.

USE OF ENGLISH REFERENCE

MODAL VERBS OF POSSIBILITY AND ABILITY

1. We use **can**, **could**, **be able to**, and **managed to** like this:

- He **can cook**.
- He **could cook**.
- She **was able to finish** on time.
- She **managed to finish** on time.

2. **Can** and **could** always have the same form.

- Timmy **can play** the piano.
- When I was 7, I **could swim** more than 200 metres.

The negative forms are **cannot** (one word) and **could not** (two words), with short forms **can't** and **couldn't**.

- We **cannot accept** applications after the closing date.
- She's sorry she **couldn't come** yesterday.

We start questions with **can** and **could** (not do).

- **Can** you **speak** another language?

NOT ~~Do you can speak?~~

- **Could** you **ride** a bike when you were four?

NOT ~~Did you could ride?~~

3. Ability

We use **can** to talk about ability:

- Our daughter **can tie** her own shoes.
- How many languages **can** you **speak**?

We use **must**, **can't**, **may**, **might** and **could** like this:

Jenny **might know** the answer,

1. Certainty

We use **must** to say that we are certain:

I haven't seen the neighbours all week. They **must be** away. (= From what I know, I can be certain that the neighbours are away.)

Lara has her hair done almost everyday. It **must cost** a fortune. (= I can be certain that it costs a lot of money.)

2. Impossibility

We use **can't** to say that something is impossible:

The man in the photo **can't be** Peter because he never wears a hat. (= From what we know, we can say that the man is not Peter.)

Anna **can't win** the race now - she's too far behind. (= We can predict that Anna won't win the race.)

3. Possibility

We use **may**, **might** and **could** to talk about present possibilities, and to talk about future possibilities:

Your blue shirt **may be** in the big cupboard. (= From what we know, perhaps the shirt is in the cupboard.)

She **might come** and see you tomorrow. (= From what we know, perhaps she will come.)

We use **may not** and **might not** (**mightn't**) in negative sentences, but not **could not**. We use these structures to say that it is possible that something won't happen:

Ed **may not know** how to find our house. (OR Ed might not know...) (= Perhaps he won't know ...)

4. We use **could** to talk about past ability in general:

- Sam **couldn't walk** until he was 18 months old.
- **Could** you **write** before you started school?

5. We usually express future ability with **will be able to**:

- You'll **be able to operate** the machinery at the end of this course.

But we can use **can** if the ability to do something in the future depends on something else happening in the present or future:

- You **can/will be able to pass** this exam if you start revising now.

6. We use **was/were** able to and **managed to** for actions that were completed at a particular moment in the past:

- The coach caught fire but all the passengers **were able/managed** to escape.

USE OF ENGLISH REFERENCE

MODAL VERBS OF POSSIBILITY AND ABILITY

Modern technology

Complete this text about modern technology with *can*, *can't*, *could* or *couldn't*.

You *can't*⁰ deny that modern technology has changed our lives. With it, we *can*⁰ do things now that we¹ do at all only a few years ago. For example, 10 years ago you² only phone from a building or a telephone box but now we³ make a call wherever we are, and previously you⁴ only use telephones to make phone calls but now you⁵ also take photos with them. Of course, in the old days you⁶ take photos with a camera, but you⁷ take them without a film. Digital cameras⁸ take hundreds of photos without a film, though you still⁹ make copies of your photos without a printer. Another thing is music. A few years ago you¹⁰ only listen to your music collection at home but now, thanks to MP3 players, you¹¹ listen to it in the street or on the bus. As for computers, 20 years ago people¹² do simple sums with a calculator but today, modern computers¹³ solve enormous mathematical problems in a few seconds. And then there's the Internet. With the Internet you¹⁴ send messages in an instant, and if you've got a question, you¹⁵ use Wikipedia to find the answer. My grandfather says that he¹⁶ believe how quickly everything has changed, he's always saying that you¹⁷ do any of those things when he was young. However, as I tell him, you¹⁸ enjoy the benefits of mobile phones, digital cameras, and computers unless you have enough money to pay for them.

What to do, where to go

Holly and Adam have just got married and have gone on their honeymoon. A friend talks to Holly's mother about their plans for the future. Rewrite the parts in brackets using *must*, *can't* or *may/might*.

- FRIEND Just married and on their honeymoon. *They must be*⁰ (I'm sure they're) very happy. Where are they going to live after they come back?
- MOTHER *They may stay*⁰ (Perhaps they'll stay) with us for a while.
- FRIEND What about work?
- MOTHER They¹ (Maybe they'll go) abroad for a year.
- FRIEND So Holly² (I assume that Holly's not) very interested in the job she's got. I thought she enjoyed her work.
- MOTHER She does, but they both have one of those temporary contracts, and the company³ (perhaps the company won't renew) them.
- FRIEND Yes, that's always a possibility.
- MOTHER Or they⁴ (maybe they'll take) a postgraduate course.
- FRIEND Would they get a grant?
- MOTHER No, I don't think so but they've both worked for a couple of years so they⁵ (I'm sure they have) some savings.
- FRIEND But Adam's father has his own business, doesn't he? He⁶ (Maybe he'll find) work for them.
- MOTHER I'm not sure. Holly quite likes Adam's father but she⁷ (perhaps she won't want) to work for him.
- FRIEND You see. It's not easy to work for in-laws and it⁸ (I'm sure it isn't) easy to live with them, either.
- MOTHER All right. I see your point.

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